

MAYBEWELL BOOKS ★



FOR EVERY CHAPTER

FOR EVERY CHAPTER · FACILITATOR EDITION

Activity Coordinator Kit

Five Group Activities, One Kit, a Whole Calendar



FOR ACTIVITY COORDINATORS

one kit, a whole calendar.

maybewellbooks.com

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HOW TO USE THIS KIT

Built for Your Job

You run activities for a room of people with eighty-year head starts on each other. This kit gives you five sessions that need almost nothing: paper, pencils, and the lives already in the room.

GUIDES Each activity gets two pages: how to run it, then how to adapt it for mobility, vision, and hearing needs — because a plan that only works for the healthiest half of the room isn't a plan.

MATERIALS Always minimal, always listed. Nothing here needs a budget meeting.

PLANNING The weekly grid at the back is photocopiable — schedule which activity runs which day and pin it where families see it.

Two of these activities pair with their own full books (Interview Me Group Edition, Memory Bingo). The other three run straight from this kit. Mix freely; repeat monthly — different rooms make them new.

Interview Me — Group Edition

A facilitator-led group interview: you read one question aloud, everyone answers, then the room compares. The companion book gives each page three answer columns; without it, index cards work fine.

GROUP

3-8 people

TIME

45-60 minutes

MATERIALS

The companion book (or index cards), pencils

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Pick one category for the day — Childhood is the safest opener.
2. Read each question aloud twice, slowly. Give a quiet minute.
3. Everyone writes a short answer — a phrase is enough.
4. Go around the room and hear the answers out loud.
5. Always close the round with: "Did anyone have a very different answer?"

Everyone plays.

Adjustments so the whole room can join — not just the healthiest half.

- **MOBILITY**

Nothing to pass or carry; a helper can scribe for anyone whose hands tire. Answers can be fully spoken.

- **VISION**

The question is read aloud, so eyes are optional. Seat low-vision residents beside a neighbor who'll reread quietly.

- **HEARING**

Write the question big on a whiteboard as you read it. Face the room; don't walk while talking.

VARIATION — Pair week: split into pairs, each pair interviews each other with the same three questions, then reports the best answer they heard (not their own).

Memory Bingo

Bingo where every square is a life experience — "Learned to drive on a manual transmission" — so every marked square is a story waiting to be asked for. The companion book has the caller list and ten unique cards, photocopiable.

GROUP

4-16 people

TIME

30-45 minutes

MATERIALS

The companion game book (photocopy the cards), pencils or bold markers

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Hand out one card per player; no two neighbors need the same card.
2. Call phrases from the list in any order, big and slow, twice each.
3. Players mark squares that are true of THEM — honor system.
4. Every few calls, ask someone who marked: "Tell us about that."
5. Four in a row wins. Play a second round; the stories change.

Everyone plays.

Adjustments so the whole room can join — not just the healthiest half.

- **MOBILITY**

Bold markers beat pencils for weaker grips. A helper can mark for anyone who calls out their squares.

- **VISION**

Cards are large-print 4x4 by design. For very low vision, pair players — one reads, both decide.

- **HEARING**

Hold up a written card of each phrase as you call it, or write it on a whiteboard. Repeat on request, always.

VARIATION — Story bingo: winner must retell (kindly) the best story someone ELSE told during the game to claim the win.

Tell Someone New

A paired icebreaker built for the newest resident. Questions start light and get personal the way real trust does. The companion book runs one pair for thirty pages; in a group, run it as a welcome session with rotating pairs.

GROUP

2, or pairs in a group

TIME

20-40 minutes

MATERIALS

The companion book (one per pair), or this kit's questions read aloud; pencils

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Pair the new resident with a settled, warm one. That pairing IS the activity.
2. Both people answer every question — nobody just interviews anybody.
3. Start with the light questions; never open with a heavy one.
4. Let pairs go at their own pace; ten questions is a fine session.
5. End by having each pair set a next time to talk — and write it down.

Everyone plays.

Adjustments so the whole room can join — not just the healthiest half.

- **MOBILITY**

Seat pairs before starting; nothing moves after that. Writing is optional — talking is the point.

- **VISION**

One partner reads aloud for both. The book's large print keeps the reader from straining either.

- **HEARING**

Quiet corner, chairs angled close, faces visible. Slip the reader a card: "speak slowly, not loudly."

VARIATION — Welcome circle: whole group, one light question, everyone answers — then the new resident picks the next question.

One Photo, One Story — Group Circle

The companion keepsake book is solo, but the group version is simple: everyone brings one photograph and tells the story behind it. No photo requirement for joining — borrowed prompts work: "describe a photo you WISH existed."

GROUP

4-10 people

TIME

30-45 minutes

MATERIALS

One photo per person (requested a week ahead), the book's prompts read aloud

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Announce it a week early: "bring one photo, any photo."
2. Go in a circle: hold the photo up, say who, where, and roughly when.
3. Then ask one deeper prompt from the book — "who's missing from this photo that you wish were there?"
4. Let the room ask one question per photo before moving on.
5. Close by inviting anyone to start the full book with today's photo.

Everyone plays.

Adjustments so the whole room can join — not just the healthiest half.

- **MOBILITY**

Photos pass hand to hand, or a helper walks them around. Nobody stands.

- **VISION**

The teller describes the photo out loud first — which is the activity anyway. Large photos beat small prints.

- **HEARING**

One speaker at a time, facilitator repeats each answer's key line back to the room.

VARIATION — Mystery pile: photos go face-down in the middle; each person draws one and the OWNER tells its story when it surfaces.

Trivia by Decade — Table Teams

The companion trivia book rewards lived memory — questions like "what did a soda fountain sell besides soda?" In a group, run it as table teams by decade; arguments between tables are the game working as intended.

GROUP

6-20 people, in teams of 2-4

TIME

30-45 minutes

MATERIALS

The companion book, paper and pencils per team

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Split into tables; each table names itself after a year they loved.
2. Read one question aloud, twice. Tables confer for one minute.
3. Each table reports; the room votes on the best (not just right) answer.
4. Use the book's answer notes to stir agreement — or an argument.
5. Rotate decades each round so every table gets its home decade once.

Everyone plays.

Adjustments so the whole room can join — not just the healthiest half.

- **MOBILITY**

Teams stay seated the whole session; a runner (staff) collects any written answers.

- **VISION**

All questions are read aloud; nothing needs to be read at the tables.

- **HEARING**

Repeat every question at a second volume, then write the decade and key phrase on a whiteboard.

VARIATION — Reverse trivia: a table states a memory ("bread was 19 cents"), the others guess the decade.

This Week at a Glance

Photocopy this page. One line per day — activity, time, room. Pin it where residents and families actually look.

	ACTIVITY	TIME	ROOM
MONDAY			
TUESDAY			
WEDNESDAY			
THURSDAY			
FRIDAY			
SATURDAY			
SUNDAY			

This Week at a Glance

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	ACTIVITY	TIME	ROOM
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The room does the real work.

You just put the chairs in a circle. Same time next week.

5 activities · 1 facilitator · a whole calendar ·



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